MAKEMYTRIP FLIGHT BOOKING

Independent Product Teardown — Analyzing the Flight-Selection Experience Through an APM Lens

TEARDOWN SCOPE BOUNDARY

01. Search Input → 02. Flight Results → 03. Attribute Evaluation → 04. Flight Selection

Disclaimer: Independent analysis based on observable product experience. Internal MakeMyTrip analytics, user research, and proprietary data were not available.

PRIMARY INQUIRY

"Does MakeMyTrip help users efficiently choose the flight that best fits their needs, or does the experience primarily help users find options?"

Core Focus: Cognitive evaluation load & multi-attribute decision synthesis.

USER CONTEXT & INTENT

Who Are We Optimizing For?

PRIMARY USER

Domestic Flight Traveler

Leisure or self-directed business traveler balancing schedule, budget, baggage, and convenience constraints.

CORE JOB-TO-BE-DONE (JTBD)

"When I search for a flight, I want to quickly identify the option that best fits my priorities so I can book confidently without manually comparing every alternative."

Multi-Dimensional User Priorities: Net Price | Departure Time | Duration | Stops | Baggage Terms | Flexibility

USER GOAL

Confidently choose the flight offering the best trade-off across personal priorities.

CURRENT PRODUCT TASK

Ingest, filter, and present available inventory meeting baseline query parameters.

CRITICAL PM QUESTION

Does the product sufficiently bridge the gap between finding options and choosing the right option?

User Persona Scope: Derived from standard domestic travel booking patterns in high-density airline routes across India.

JOURNEY MAPPING

Current MMT User Journey

[01. SEARCH] → [02. RESULTS] → [03. FILTER/SORT] → [04. COMPARE] → [05. SELECT] End-to-End Search Experience

01 SEARCH

USER ACTION:
Inputs origin, destination, date, and passenger count.

SYSTEM BEHAVIOR:
Queries flight inventory across airlines.

POTENTIAL FRICTION:
Captures route parameters, but not nuanced multi-factor priority preferences.

02 RESULTS

USER ACTION:
Scans multiple flight cards across the results set.

SYSTEM BEHAVIOR:
Presents cards sorted by the default ranking.

POTENTIAL FRICTION:
Users must mentally parse multiple attributes per flight card simultaneously.

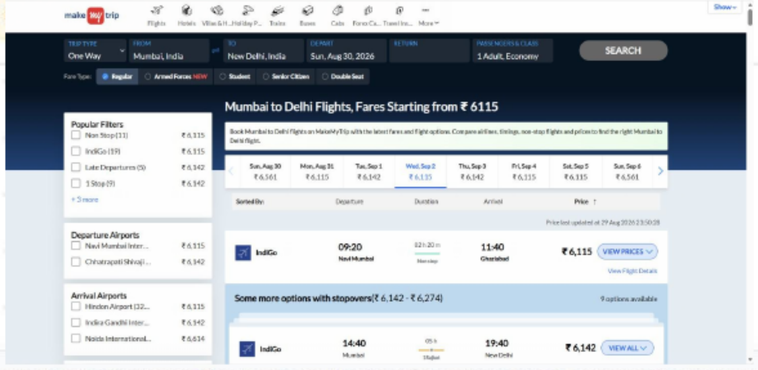
03 FILTER / SORT

USER ACTION:
Applies timing, stop, and airline filters.

SYSTEM BEHAVIOR:
Narrows the list and sorts along a single axis.

POTENTIAL FRICTION:
Filters can narrow result set, but users may still need to compare

REAL MMT EXPERIENCE



04 COMPARE

USER ACTION:
Switches between candidate flights.

SYSTEM BEHAVIOR:
Static catalog presentation without contextual comparison assistance.

POTENTIAL FRICTION:
Users must synthesize trade-offs themselves.

05 SELECT

USER ACTION:
Selects fare tier and proceeds to add-ons.

SYSTEM BEHAVIOR:
Displays baggage, seat, meal, and insurance options.

POTENTIAL FRICTION:
Additional fare/add-on info may create selection hesitation or require reassessing choice.

Note on Friction: Labels indicate potential user friction points inferred from interface structure; they represent product opportunities rather than measured abandonment metrics.

HEURISTIC TEARDOWN

Where Does Decision Friction Appear?

01. ATTRIBUTE DENSITY

COGNITIVE LOAD

OBSERVATION: Multiple attributes such as price, departure, duration, stops, baggage, and promotional information are presented simultaneously across flight cards.

USER IMPACT: Users need to evaluate several attributes together across competing candidate options.

PM INTERPRETATION: **Information availability is high, but cognitive synthesis remains largely user-driven.**

02. UNIVARIATE SORTING

RANKING LIMITS

OBSERVATION: Sorting optimizes along one variable at a time, such as Cheapest or Fastest.

USER IMPACT: Optimizing one dimension can compromise another dimension (e.g., cheap flight with inconvenient red-eye time).

PM INTERPRETATION: **Single-variable sorting may not fully reflect multi-criteria user intent.**

03. FILTER-TO-DECISION GAP

DECISION SUPPORT

OBSERVATION: Filters narrow the search space to a subset of candidates matching baseline criteria.

USER IMPACT: Users still need to determine which remaining option is the best overall trade-off.

PM INTERPRETATION: **Filtering solves discovery and elimination, not necessarily decision synthesis.**

04. HETEROGENEOUS PREFERENCES

PERSONALIZATION

OBSERVATION: Flights with similar prices can have meaningfully different departure times, durations, and stops.

USER IMPACT: The best option depends heavily on the individual traveler's priorities and constraints.

PM INTERPRETATION: **A single static ranking may not satisfy divergent user preferences.**

Teardown Criteria: Evaluated using Nielsen-Norman usability heuristics and cognitive load frameworks on standard domestic flight listings.

COGNITIVE LOAD MODELING

From Option Discovery to Decision Synthesis

Attribute	Flight A	Flight B	Flight C	Flight D	Flight E	Flight F
Net Price	₹4,850	₹5,600	₹4,600	₹5,100	₹6,200	₹5,300
Departure	05:45 AM	08:30 AM	06:15 AM	11:20 PM	09:15 AM	04:30 PM
Duration	2h 15m	2h 45m	2h 20m	3h 10m	2h 10m	2h 15m
Stops	Non-stop	Non-stop	Non-stop	1 Stop (BLR)	Non-stop	Non-stop
Included Baggage	15 kg	25 kg	15 kg	Cabin Only	15 kg	15 kg

6 Options × 5 Attributes
= 30 Attribute Evaluations

Attribute Evaluation Load: Core Insight: Users repeatedly compare these attributes against their personal priorities before selecting a flight. Filtering narrows rows, but leaves trade-off synthesis to mental math.

Disclaimer: Conceptual model of cognitive evaluation effort — not measured user behavioral telemetry.

PROBLEM PRIORITIZATION

Which Problem Should We Solve First?

ID	Candidate Problem Statement	Impact	Freq	Conf	Priority Tier
P1	**Multi-Attribute Comparison** (Users manually reconcile trade-offs)	5	5	4	P0 PRIMARY
P2	**Single-Dimension Sort Limitation** (Isolates 1 variable, distorts intent)	4	5	4	P1 / HIGH
P3	**Filter-to-Decision Gap** (Narrows list, but doesn't resolve fit)	4	4	3	P1 / HIGH
P4	**Limited Trade-Off Synthesis** (Presents inventory without trade-off aid)	4	4	3	P1 / HIGH
P5	**Information Density** (Visual & cognitive comparison effort)	3	3	4	P2 / MED

Strategic Focus: • **P0 PRIMARY:** Decision Synthesis Support | • **P1 FOCUS:** Intent-Driven Ranking / Multi-Attribute Comparison & Filter-to-Decision Gap | • **P2 FOCUS:** Information Density Management

Scoring Basis: PM assessment — directional, not measured product analytics.

DIAGNOSTIC FRAMEWORK

What Is the Underlying Product Problem?

01. OBSERVABLE SYMPTOM

"Users may spend additional effort scanning, re-filtering and cross-comparing multiple viable flights."

↓

02. USER PROBLEM

"Users must manually determine which option provides the best composite value across their personal combination of priorities."

↓

03. ROOT CAUSE HYPOTHESIS

"Existing filtering helps narrow the option set, but does not fully synthesize trade-offs across the user's combined priorities."

The product is primarily optimized for **Option Discovery** rather than **Decision Support**.

Disclaimer: Working PM hypothesis to validate via user research and experimentation, not an internal diagnosis of MakeMyTrip.

STRATEGIC OPPORTUNITY

The Product Hypothesis

PM CORE HYPOTHESIS

"If the product identifies the flight that best matches a user's explicitly stated preferences and clearly explains the trade-offs, users may make decisions faster and with greater confidence."

* This hypothesis should be validated through controlled experimentation.

CURRENT STATE

Option Discovery

Passive catalog scan, single-dimension sorting, and manual filtering.

VALUE OPPORTUNITY

Decision Support

Active trade-off synthesis, composite utility weighting, and recommendation rationale.

GOVERNANCE

Without Removing Agency

User retains full authority to override, explore catalog, or adjust weights.

Role of AI: AI can synthesize available options against explicit user priorities and explain why an option is recommended.

Experimentation Guardrail: Hypothesis targets cognitive friction reduction without locking users into opaque algorithmic walled gardens.

PRODUCT CONCEPT & ARCHITECTURE

Proposed Concept — Skybound Travels

FICTIONAL AI DECISION-SUPPORT CONCEPT DERIVED FROM THE MAKEMYTRIP TEARDOWN • NOT AN EXISTING MAKEMYTRIP FEATURE

DECISION-SUPPORT PIPELINE



✕ NOT CHEAPEST

An early 03:30 AM flight saving ₹200 is not optimal for a daytime traveler.

✕ NOT FASTEST

A flight saving 15 mins at a ₹3,500 premium is not optimal for a budget-conscious traveler.

✓ BEST MATCH DEFINITION

The option that best fits the user's stated multi-criteria priorities and constraints.

Disclaimer: Illustrative concept — not an existing MakeMyTrip feature or brand asset.

DECISION LOGIC & REASONING

How the AI Would Reason

1. HARD CONSTRAINTS (BOOLEAN GATE)

DEFINES ELIGIBILITY

- ✓ Budget ≤ ₹7,000
- ✓ Non-stop flight only
- ✓ Included check-in baggage ≥ 15 kg

2. SOFT PREFERENCES (WEIGHTED UTILITY)

RANKS ELIGIBLE FLIGHTS

- Preferred departure window: Morning (07:00 – 11:00)
- Price sensitivity: Moderate
- Duration sensitivity: High

"Hard constraints define eligibility; soft preferences determine ranking among eligible options."

3. MATCH SCORE → 4. TOP CONTRIBUTING FACTORS → 5. EXPLANATION

SYNTHESIZED OUTPUT EXAMPLE:

"Recommended because it is **within budget**, **non-stop**, includes your **15 kg baggage requirement**, and matches your preferred **morning departure window**."

SAFETY & RELIABILITY

AI Should Fail Safely

01. LOW CONFIDENCE STATE

SCORE PARITY

Scenario: Several flights score similarly across priority weights.

→ **Response: Present the top 2–3 balanced options rather than forcing a single recommendation.**

02. DYNAMIC FARE CHANGE

REAL-TIME UPDATE

Scenario: Airline price changes before booking.

→ **Response: Recalculate the recommendation and clearly explain the fare delta.**

03. CONSTRAINT EXHAUSTION

ZERO MATCH

Scenario: No flight satisfies all hard constraints.

→ **Response: Suggest the nearest constraint relaxation while preserving user control.**

04. STALE PREFERENCES

USER DRIFT

Scenario: User intent changes during the session.

→ **Response: Allow the user to quickly reset or edit preferences via 1-tap controls.**

Bottom Principle: "AI should recommend, explain, and preserve user control — never silently decide."

MEASUREMENT & EXPERIMENTATION

How I Would Know It Works

Control Variant (A): Existing MakeMyTrip flight listing with standard sorting/filtering.

Treatment Variant (B): Standard listing + Explainable Best Match decision-support module.

PRIMARY METRIC

Search → Booking Conversion

Overall checkout completion rate among search session initiators.

SECONDARY METRIC

Time to Flight Selection

Reduction in evaluation friction and time to pick first candidate.

DIAGNOSTIC METRIC

Best Match Selection Rate

Recommendation relevance, click-through, and user adoption.

GUARDRAIL METRICS

Downstream Regret

Cancellation Rate | Refund Rate | Support Contact Rate | CSAT.

Success Standard: "Success is not simply higher recommendation adoption. The experience must improve decision efficiency without increasing downstream regret, cancellations, refunds or support contacts."